

Municipal Unit Strategic Taskforce (MUST) Meeting - September 29th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1aPqrqLXOYg
Publication Date	2026-09-30T16:02:28Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Budget Hearing Meeting Summary

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Delaware County Council 2027 Budget Hearing [00:07:47](#).
- **Summary of Discussion:** Review and finalization of instructions to the auditor's office for the 2027 budget, targeting an ending cash balance of approximately \$5.57 million to avoid short-term borrowing. The council deliberated on educational incentive adjustments, departmental salary increases (comparing percentage vs. lump-sum raises), moving certain sheriff's department merit deputies into the Local Income Tax (LIT) Public Safety fund, department-by-department personnel allocations, and potential transitions to a 40-hour work week.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer reconvened the Delaware County Council 2027 budget hearing [00:07:47](#).

- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** All council members were present 00:08:15.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Hughes 00:08:58.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance 00:07:50.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not addressed during this session.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(The council worked through a detailed, department-by-department review of 2027 salary recommendations, adjusting figures to prepare final instructions for the auditor.)

- **00:13:26 Educational Incentive Adjustments:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office / Council President.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Confirmed the inclusion of educational incentive adjustments for Data IT, Treasurer, Coroner, Prosecutor, and Courts. For the Board of Health (Fund 1159), a negative adjustment of \$2,496 was designated to be taken from health insurance to fund incentive pay.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **01:06:53 County General & Departmental Salary Baselines:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council established a baseline percentage model for department staff (generally starting at 1% to 2% and adjusting upward for specific public safety or high-turnover needs), while excluding elected officials from across-the-board percentage increases until a separate structured adjustment could be applied.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **03:18:55 Elected Officials & Chief Deputies Salary Adjustments:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Settled on setting the salaries for the seven elected officials (Clerk, Auditor, Treasurer, Recorder, Surveyor, Coroner, and Assessor) at \$60,840, and their chief deputies at 85% of that amount (\$51,714). Commissioners and County Council members were excluded from this adjustment.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:38:10 Tom Borchers (Delaware County Surveyor):** Expressed surprise and concern regarding a proposal to eliminate a vacant office assistant position in his department, noting staffing shortages and the heavy workload carried by remaining personnel.
- **00:40:44 Brad Holt (Delaware County Treasurer):** Addressed the council regarding the practical challenges of staffing during peak tax collection season, warning against hiring freezes or uncompensated increases to a 40-hour work week without adequate pay adjustments.
- **00:48:07 Tanya Dunmore (Chief Deputy Auditor):** Spoke on internal office equity, noting that supervisors and chief deputies often make less than specialized staff and highlighting the dedication of county employees over long tenures.
- **01:13:32 Rick (County Clerk / Clerk's Office):** Discussed high staff turnover, wage disparities with court staff, and the operational impacts of losing experienced personnel.
- **01:38:35 Assessor's Office Representative / Chief Deputy Assessor:** Noted qualification requirements (Level 2 certifications) for assessors and staff, wage comparisons with neighboring counties, and the impacts of the job study guidelines.
- **02:05:36 Heidi Knuckles (GIS / EMA Office Manager):** Spoke in support of GIS and EMA staff, highlighting overtime hours and operational responsibilities during emergency events.
- **02:26:47 Nikki Baskin (CASA Director):** Detailed the heavy caseloads, required evening/weekend travel, and high experience levels of CASA staff, advocating for a 4% salary increase.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The auditor's office will input the agreed percentage adjustments into OpenGov over the coming days to calculate exact figures, including workers' compensation adjustments.
 - Scheduled budget adoption meeting set for next Wednesday, the 7th at 9:00 A.M. **00:08:33**, with a resolution on givebacks.
- **Adjournment:** Motion to recess made, seconded, and approved by voice vote **00:44:25**.